

Most Phillies Expect Herrera to Play

By ALLEN LEWIS
Inquirer Reporter
CLEARWATER, Fla.

March 15.

Almost a month remains before the National League season opens, but few of the Phillies will bet against Frank Herrera opening the season as the club's regular second baseman. Stationing the husky Cuban at the sack was an experiment. Like most experiments, this one led to a discovery—that Frank can really handle himself at the position.

Herrera's play was the sub-

ject of discussion Tuesday in the Jack Russell Stadium Clubhouse while the players awaited a decision on whether the weather would permit their game with the Washington Senators to be played. Despite the fact that the sun eventually made its appearance the grounds were deemed too wet for the regular contest.

The International League's most valuable player as a member of the pennant-winning Buffalo club last year, Herrera played second base in an intrasquad game last week and then

filled the bill Monday as the Phils defeated the Pittsburgh Pirates at Fort Myers. While he had no especially difficult chances, he looked at home and pivoted perfectly on a double play that pulled the Phils out of a hole in the eighth inning.

Normally a first baseman, and a fancy dan with the mitt, Herrera has played some at third base and the outfield, but never before at second.

"I never even played there in school," Herrera said, "but I like it, and I think I can play there."

"Right now I am too heavy, but I take off 10 or 15 more pounds and it will help me a lot. I have trouble coming in on slow hit ball until I take weight off. Then I think I be all right."

Manager Eddie Sawyer, who put Herrera at second just "to see how he looks," is now giving the move more serious consideration after watching the 6-3, 220-pounder move around the bag.

"He seems to be a little more comfortable there than he was at third," Sawyer said. "I think

it's because he's used to that side of the infield. That can make quite a difference, you know."

"Despite his size," Sawyer added, "he's quick and he's agile, and he seems to have the natural flip throw you need on a lot of plays around second."

"We've got to get his bat in the lineup somewhere, and he would probably make the best No. 4 hitter we've got, even if he doesn't hit too much for averages."

"I know one thing," Sawyer

concluded, "if he does play second he'll be the biggest in the Big Leagues, and one of the biggest that ever played second base."

Coach Andy Cohen, an old second baseman in his playing days, has been given the job of

teaching Herrera some of the fine points of the position.

"He's enthusiastic about playing there," Cohen reported, "and he's improving every day. If we can just get some of that weight off him, it will help."